



RKDF UNIVERSITY, BHOPAL

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.)

Course	Category	Subject	Subject Code
B.A.	Major	B.A. Major American English Literature	BA-EN301
Total Credit: 6		Max.Marks:100 (Internal:40+External:60)	

SYLLABUS

I Drama Tennessee Williams:

The Streetcar Named Desire. Keywords: illusion. Reality, hopelessness 1820

II Novel Toni Morrison:

Beloved Keywords: Slave trade, Identity Crisis, Alienation, Gothic Fiction. Motherhood, and Familial responsibility, guilt and repentance 1820

III Short Story Edgar Allan Poe: “The Purloined Letter”

Ernest Hemingway: “*Cat in the Rain*” Keywords: Mystery, Racism, Self-pity, And Isolation

18 20

IV Poetry Emily Dickinson: *“Hope is the thing with feathers”*

A bird came Down the walk” Walt Whitman: “Selections from Leaves of Grass:”

“O Captain, My Captain” “Passage to India”(lines 1-68)

Keywords: *Proto Feminism, Alcoholism, Suffering 1820*

V Alexie Sherman Alexie: *“Crow Testament” Evolution William Faulkner: “A Rose For Emily”*

UNIT I

A Streetcar Named Desire by Tennessee Williams, first performed in 1947, is a classic American play that unfolds in the vibrant and tumultuous setting of New Orleans. The story revolves around Blanche DuBois, a fragile and troubled woman who moves in with her sister, Stella, and her brother-in-law, Stanley Kowalski. As the dynamics between the characters develop, the play explores themes of sex and gender roles, mental instability, and mortality in the face of the gritty realities of the post-World War II era.

Set against the backdrop of a gritty New Orleans neighborhood, the play captures the heat, sensuality, and social tensions of the time and place. The sultry atmosphere intensifies the conflict between Blanche’s illusions of grandeur and Stanley’s raw, primal force. Tennessee Williams masterfully delves into the complexities of human relationships, exposing the fragility of the human psyche and the destructive power of desire.

A Streetcar Named Desire has had a significant impact on American theater and culture. The play has been adapted into multiple film and television productions, with the 1951 film directed by Elia Kazan starring Vivien Leigh as Blanche and Marlon Brando as Stanley earning critical

acclaim. The enduring relevance of the play lies in its exploration of universal themes and its iconic characters that continue to resonate with audiences today.

UNIT II

The novel is based on the true story of a Black slave woman, Margaret Garner, who in 1856 escaped from a Kentucky plantation with her husband, Robert, and their children. They sought refuge in [Ohio](#), but their owner and law officers soon caught up with the family. Before their recapture, Margaret killed her young daughter to prevent her return to slavery. In the novel, Sethe is also a passionately devoted mother, who flees with her children from an abusive owner known as “schoolteacher.” They are caught, and, in an act of supreme love and sacrifice, she too tries to kill her children to keep them from slavery. Only her two-year-old daughter dies, and the schoolteacher, believing that Sethe is crazy, decides not to take her back. Sethe later has “Beloved” inscribed on her daughter’s tombstone. Although she had intended for it to read “Dearly Beloved,” she did not have the energy to “pay” for two words (each word cost her 10 minutes of sex with the engraver).

On the edge of Cincinnati, in 1873 just after the end of the Civil War, there is a house numbered 124 that is haunted by the presence of a dead child. A former slave named Sethe has lived in the house, with its ghost, for 18 years. Sethe lives at 124 with her daughter **Denver**. Her mother-in-law, **Baby Suggs**, died eight years previously after languishing for years with exhaustion and seeming overwhelming sadness. And her two sons, **Howard and Buglar**, ran away from the haunted home just before Baby Suggs’ death.

Paul D, a former slave who used to work on the same plantation, called Sweet Home, as Sethe, arrives at 124 and moves in, making a kind of family with Denver and Sethe. Paul D awakens

painful memories for Sethe and Denver is jealous of the attention and affection that Sethe gives to him. But just as Denver is getting used to the new familial arrangement, a strange woman appears at the house. She calls herself **Beloved** and says that she doesn't know who she is or where she is from.

Beloved asks Sethe many questions about her past and somehow seems to know about things only Sethe knew, such as about a pair of earrings Sethe received as a gift from the wife of her former master. Denver loves having Beloved around the house and eagerly tells her about the miracle of her own birth: Sethe escaped from Sweet Home while pregnant with Denver and almost died of hunger and exhaustion while trying to make it to Ohio. But white women named Amy Denver found Sethe, cared for her, and helped her get to the Ohio River, where she gave birth to Denver. Sethe named Denver after the kind white woman.

Paul D recalls his experience working on a chain gang. He and the other slaves eventually escaped together and had their chains cut by a group of Cherokee. Paul D wandered north and stayed with a kind woman in Delaware for some time, but he was unable to settle. He felt an urge to wander and did so for years before coming to 124.

Missing Baby Suggs, Sethe takes Beloved and Denver to the clearing in the woods where Baby Suggs used to have spiritual gatherings before she fell into her exhausted state. Sethe wishes that Baby Suggs were there to rub her neck and suddenly she feels other-worldly fingers massaging her neck. But then the fingers begin to choke her until they finally let go. Denver thinks that Beloved is somehow behind the choking, but Beloved denies it.

Beloved gradually and mysteriously forces Paul D out of the house by making him restless, so that he ends up sleeping outside in the cold house. When he is sleeping outside in the cold house

one night, she persuades him to sleep with her and stirs up his painful memories. Beloved tells Denver that she wants Paul D out of 124.

The novel moves back in time to follow Baby Suggs as she waits for Sethe and her son **Halle** (Sethe's husband). Sethe has snuck her children out of Sweet Home and sent them ahead to 124, and she and Halle are supposed to escape together and come to the house. Halle never arrives, but Sethe does, and Baby Suggs is happy to have at least Sethe and her children reunited. She hosts a grand celebration for the neighboring community and her meager stores of food miraculously furnish a huge feast for ninety people. After the celebration, she feels uneasy, and realizes that she has offended the community with an excessive display of joy and pride. She senses that something bad is coming as a consequence.

Soon after the celebration, four horsemen come to 124: **Schoolteacher** (who became the owner of Sweet Home after the kinder original master died), his nephew, a slave catcher, and a sheriff. They have come to take Sethe and her children back to Sweet Home to work as slaves. The offended community does not warn Sethe or Baby Suggs, and when Sethe sees Schoolteacher coming, she gathers her children and runs to a shed. When the four horsemen find her, she has killed one child with a saw and is ready to kill her other children. Schoolteacher decides that she is crazy and not worth bringing back to work. The sheriff takes Sethe off to jail.

Back in the present, a former slave named **Stamp Paid** (who helped Sethe escape to 124 eighteen years ago) tells Paul D about Sethe's killing her own child. Paul D confronts Sethe about it, and then leaves 124. Feeling guilty for causing Paul D to leave Sethe, Stamp Paid goes to 124 to talk to Sethe. But she does not come to the door. Stamp Paid hears strange voices from the house and sees Beloved through a window.

Within the house, Beloved causes Sethe to remember more and more of her painful past. The novel follows Sethe's stream of consciousness as Sethe maintains that her killing her child was an act of love. Sethe believes that Beloved is the returned spirit of her dead child. The novel then follows the thoughts of Denver and Beloved. In a series of vivid but fragmented recollections, Beloved remembers being taken on a ship from Africa to the United States, the "middle passage" of the Atlantic slave trade.

Sethe begins to get weaker and weaker, falling under the sway of Beloved, whose every whim Sethe obeys. Denver ventures out of the house in search of work, to try to get food and provide for the household. She goes to the house of the **Bodwins**, who once helped Baby Suggs settle at 124, and tells their maid **Janey** about Beloved and the situation at 124. The community rallies together to supply food to 124.

As news spreads of Beloved's strange presence at 124, a group of women join together to rescue Sethe and Denver from her. They gather around 124 and break into song, in a kind of exorcism. Mr. Bodwin approaches the house and Sethe mistakes him for Schoolteacher. Crazed, she tries to attack him but is restrained by Denver and other women. Beloved disappears.

After Beloved's departure, 124 seems to become a normal household. Sethe has mostly lost her mind, but Denver is working and learning, hoping one day to attend college. Paul D returns to 124 and promises to always care for Sethe. The inhabitants of 124 and the surrounding community gradually forget about Beloved entirely, even those who saw and talked to her.

UNIT III

The unnamed narrator is with the famous Parisian amateur detective C. Auguste Dupin when they are joined by G—, prefect of the Paris police. G— brings to Dupin's attention the theft from

the queen's royal boudoir of a letter addressed to her. The thief is the unscrupulous Minister D—, who switched the letter for one of no importance during a visit with the queen and who has since been using its contents to blackmail her. Dupin agrees with two conclusions formed by G—: that the letter has not yet been made public, since doing so would lead to certain circumstances that have not yet occurred; and that D— must have it close at hand, ready to disclose at a moment's notice.

The police have thoroughly searched D—'s home (referred to as a "hotel" in keeping with Parisian word usage of the era) and person for the letter, including an exhaustive examination of the furniture, walls, and carpeting for any concealed hiding places, but have found nothing. Dupin suggests that G— and his men repeat their search and requests a description of the letter, which G— provides. A month later, the police still have nothing to show for their efforts and a frustrated G— declares that he would pay 50,000 francs to anyone who can help find the letter. Dupin tells G— to write him a check for that amount; once he has done so, Dupin produces the letter from a writing-desk and an overjoyed G— races away to return it to the queen. Dupin then explains to the narrator that the police did not take into account the psychology of their adversary in executing their search, drawing a parallel with a schoolboy he once knew who exploited his classmates' methods of thinking in order to win all their marbles at the game of Odds and Evens. The police had assumed that since the letter was so politically sensitive, D— would take great pains to conceal it; however, Dupin conjectured that it would instead be hidden in plain sight. He contrived to visit D— at his home, disguising his eyes behind green spectacles in order to covertly survey the rooms. Hanging near the mantelpiece was a cheap card-rack with a dirty, half-torn letter in one of its slots. Dupin determined that this was the missing letter, which D— had folded inside-out, re-addressed and sealed, and damaged in order to hide its nature. He left

his snuffbox behind upon departing, as an excuse to return the next day. Shortly after this second arrival, a disturbance occurred in the street outside, arranged in advance with a paid confederate. While D— was distracted, Dupin took the letter and replaced it with a duplicate he had prepared. Dupin chose not to attempt to seize the letter openly for fear that D— would have had him killed. As he both supports the queen politically and bears an old grudge against D—, he hopes that D— will try to use the duplicate in his blackmail scheme and thus bring about his own downfall. Instead of insulting D— by leaving it blank, Dupin had written a quotation from Prosper Jolyot de Crébillon's play *Atrée et Thyeste* that implies he took the original: *Un dessein si funeste, / S'il n'est digne d'Atrée, est digne de Thyeste* ("If such a sinister design is not worthy of Atreus, it is worthy of Thyestes").

CAT IN THE RAIN

An American couple is staying at a hotel in Italy. It is raining heavily one day, and the wife, looking out of their hotel room window, spies a cat under one of the tables outside, trying to shelter from the rain. She wants to go and get the cat and bring her (the cat is specifically gendered as female) indoors. Her husband, George, sits on the bed, reading, and offers to go and fetch it, but the wife says she will go. She goes downstairs and talks to the Italian hotel owner, whom she likes. Stepping outside, she is about to go looking for the cat when the maid who looks after their hotel room appears with an umbrella, telling her she mustn't get wet.

The wife fails to find the cat, and returns up to her hotel room, disappointed. She tells her husband that she wants a cat, as well as other things: she wants spring to arrive, and she wants some new clothes. But George is engrossed in his book and isn't listening. Then, at the end of

the story, the maid knocks on the door and when she enters, she is holding a large tortoiseshell cat in her arms. She tells them that the hotel-owner told her to bring the cat up for the wife.

Cat in the Rain': analysis

In keeping with Ernest Hemingway's signature style, 'Cat in the Rain' is written in spare, clear prose, using short sentences and plain dialogue. This is a trademark feature of Hemingway's style in his short stories and novels. Hemingway's stories often seem direct and matter-of-fact, as though they simply mean whatever they say, but there is, in fact, symbolic resonance to many of the ordinary and everyday details he builds his stories around. The cat in the rain is not just a cat: she clearly symbolises something more to the wife, who wishes to rescue her from the rain and, in doing so, rescue a part of herself. She, too, wants to escape the rain, as her reference to spring (which hasn't yet arrived) towards the end of the story demonstrates.

In other words, we might analyse or interpret the cat as a site of desire for the wife: the cat represents desire itself, all her wants, becoming a tangible, physical manifestation of her desire. We want what we can't have, of course: Jacques Lacan's work on desire argues as much, and in English the word 'want' denotes both a desire and a lack (i.e., you *want* an ice cream but if you fall short of some standard you are said to have been *found wanting*). Of course, the wife's initial failure to find the cat when she goes outside is also, we might say, significant: having seen what she wants, the object of desire, she then fails to attain it. The maid's role in the story is also significant in this connection. There is an intriguing relationship between the three female characters of the maid, the wife, and the cat. The wife's actions are motivated by a desire to shelter the poor cat from the harsh rain, but also because, as she acknowledges, she wants a cat (among other things). The maid, meanwhile, brings the wife an umbrella so *she* won't get wet.

So there is an intriguing echo of the wife's actions (trying to stop the cat from getting wet) in the maid's (trying to stop the wife from getting wet). 'Cat in the Rain', in short, is not *just* about a cat. The cat can be taken at face value and surface level as 'just' a cat, and the events of the story as being a minor snapshot into one hour's events in the lives of an American couple living in 1920s Italy. But since when in our own lives do events simply happen without having wider implications? Many things we do are motivated by other desires, drives, wants, fears, anxieties. This is especially true of American culture, we might say, which – in Hemingway's time as much as in ours – has often been driven by desire for material objects: a new car, a bigger house, the latest fashionable clothes, and so on. The cat cannot be separated from this mentality: it embodies it. Although the wife begins by wanting the 'cat in the rain', she later expresses the wish to have *a* cat: any cat will do. She wants a pet.

This reveals that although helping an animal in distress (the cat trying to avoid the rain under the table) may have formed part of her initial desire to rescue the animal, her actions were also driven by more selfish and materialistic desires.

Unit IV

Hope is the thing with feathers

"Hope is the thing with feathers" is a kind of hymn of praise, written to honor the human capacity for hope. Using **extended metaphor**, the poem portrays hope as a bird that lives within the human soul; this bird sings come rain or shine, gale or storm, good times or bad. The poem argues that hope is miraculous and almost impossible to defeat. Furthermore, hope never asks for anything in return—it costs nothing for people to maintain hope. By extension, then, "Hope is

the thing with feathers” implores its readers to make good use of hope—and to see it as an essential, deeply valuable part of themselves.

The poem begins by establishing its key metaphor—that hope is a bird. It then tells the reader more about this bird, adding detail, before showing it in different situations. The poem concludes by stating that, despite all it does, hope never asks for anything from the speaker. Overall, then, the poem turns hope into a vivid imagined character in order to show how important it is, both to individuals and to humanity as a whole.

The poem initially defines hope as “the thing with feathers.” Though it’s obvious that this is a bird (as confirmed in line 7), the unusualness of this first description shows that the poem wants the reader to look afresh at hope—to see hope with clear eyes and not take it for granted. Starting with “hope is a bird” would have the same literal meaning but would feel much less surprising, and the surprise element helps establish the poem’s purpose of redefining hope.

This "Hope" bird “perches” in the soul, showing that the soul itself is hope’s home. Hope is thus directly linked with the human spirit, where it sings without ever stopping. This perseverance, then, is a representation of humanity’s infinite capacity for hope. Even in the depths of despair, the poem seems to say, people can still have hope—and this hope will sustain them. Indeed, the bird sings “sweetest” in the storm. In other words, hope shows its importance in times of adversity and seems to guide people through that adversity. This point could apply to humanity’s challenges in a general sense, or it could relate to more personal experiences like individual grief and loss. In either case, hope gives people the strength to carry on, and it’s at its most useful when circumstances are at their worst.

Of course, there might be times when people do seem to lose their strength—but, the poem argues, hope still plays an important role in these situations. The poem demonstrates this by gesturing towards the sheer number of people (“so many”) who have been sustained by hope, saying that it would have to be a truly “sore” “storm” that could diminish the strength of “the little Bird.” Hope, it seems, can keep people “warm” even in the worst situations.

And though hope is so essential to human life, the beauty of it—according to the poem—is that it requires practically nothing of people. Hope costs nothing, not a “crumb”—yet it can literally and figuratively keep people alive. With hope, people can make it through the hardest of times—they just have to listen to “the little Bird” singing its tune. Overall, then, “Hope is the thing with feathers” implores its readers to value their capacity for hope—and to recognize that it’s never really gone. Without becoming overly specific, the poem argues that hope can be especially helpful in the most extreme situations and that people should therefore rely on it as a precious resource.

Line-by-Line Explanation & Analysis of “Hope is the thing with feathers”

Lines 1-2

This poem is one of a number of works by Dickinson which work as a kind of extended definition, taking a particular word and casting it in a new, surprising light. Often, Dickinson does this through taking abstract concepts and applying concrete ideas or images to them—which happens in this poem by making “hope” into a bird. Of all Dickinson’s “definition” poems, this is probably the most well-known. The opening line makes the poem’s intentions clear—it

will aim to explain how hope is like a bird, and why that connection is important in the first place.

This said, it's important to note that the poem doesn't start by stating its **metaphor** directly; it doesn't say that "hope is a bird." Aside from being much less interesting, a line like that would require less imaginative engagement on the reader's part. Instead, hope is "the thing with feathers." The reader might well think of a bird immediately, but the phrase allows for a certain conceptual distance that justifies the rest of the poem—the following lines will *explain* what this "thing" is, and in what way it represents hope. This slightly mysterious beginning implies that people might not always recognize their own capacity for hope. The delicate **consonance** of /th/ in "thing," "feathers," and "that" also helps the poem get off to a gentle start, as though it is feeling its way into this new definition of hope. The meter of the line adds to this gentleness too. It's the only one in the poem to end with an unstressed syllable (apart from possibly line 11):

“Hope” is | the **thing** | with **fea-** | -thers -

The **trochaic** first foot also places strong emphasis on the word "hope," which is, of course, the whole point of the poem: to argue for the importance of hope.

The second word of line 2, for most readers, probably confirms that this "Hope" thing is indeed a bird. "Perch" is a verb used almost exclusively for birds, and as a noun, the word has a connotation of signifying the bird's home or the place where it is at rest (think of how a bird in a cage rests on its perch). This "Hope" bird, the reader now knows, rests within "the soul," which is the poem's way of saying that hope is a fundamental part of being a human. The image also suggests that hope is always present—it's something that people can always return to, just as a bird returns to its perch.

A Bird, came down the Walk

Emily Dickinson

*A Bird, came down the Walk
He did not know I saw
He bit an Angle Worm in halves
And ate the fellow, raw,
And then, he drank a Dew
From a convenient Grass
And then hopped sidewise to the
Wall To let a Beetle pass*

*He glanced with rapid eyes,
That hurried all abroad
They looked like frightened Beads,
I thought, He stirred his Velvet Head.*

*Like one in danger,
Cautious, I offered him a Crumb,
And he unrolled his feathers,
And rowed him softer Home -*

*Than Oars divide the Ocean,
Too silver for a seam,
Or Butterflies, off Banks of Noon,
Leap, plashless as they swim.*

The speaker describes once seeing a bird come down the walk, unaware that it was being watched. The bird ate an angleworm, then “drank a Dew / From a convenient Grass—,” then hopped sideways to let a beetle pass by. The bird’s frightened, bead-like eyes glanced all around. Cautiously, the speaker offered him “a Crumb,” but the bird “unrolled his feathers” and flew away—as though rowing in the water, but with a grace gentler than that with which “Oars divide the ocean” or butterflies leap “off Banks of Noon”; the bird appeared to swim without splashing. Dickinson keenly depicts the bird as it eats a worm, pecks at the grass, hops by a beetle, and

glances around fearfully. As a natural creature frightened by the speaker into flying away, the bird becomes an emblem for the quick, lively, ungraspable wild essence that distances nature from the human beings who desire to appropriate or tame it. But the most remarkable feature of this poem is the imagery of its final stanza, in which Dickinson provides one of the most breathtaking descriptions of flying in all of poetry. Simply by offering two quick comparisons of flight and by using aquatic motion (rowing and swimming), she evokes the delicacy and fluidity of moving through air. The image of butterflies leaping “off Banks of Noon,” splashlessly swimming though the sky, is one of the most memorable in all Dickinson’s writing.

Walt Whitman's 'O Captain!, My Captain!' and 'Passage to India'

Walt Whitman's 'O Captain!, My Captain!' and 'Passage to India' in terms of their thematic content. Commenting on the imagery and language of each poem bringing out the differences and similarities. - Venus Anand

Walt Whitman, was born on the 31st May, 1819 in Long Island, New York, U.S. He was an essayist, poet and journalist, as well as a volunteer nurse in the course of the American civil war (1861-1865). Walt Whitman participated in the shift from transcendentalism towards realism, and both views are present in his works. Walt Whitman, being one of the **most influential** American poets is often referred to as "the father of the free verse". His first work was '*Leaves of Grass*' which was first published with Whitman's own money in 1855 and was described by himself to be an attempt at reaching the common person through an American epic. Inside as well as outside his poetry, Walt Whitman exposed his views on the abolition of slavery, an egalitarian view on races, even if later in his life he saw abolition, as a potential threat to democracy. Abraham Lincoln is the centre of topic in his poem named ‘O Captain!, My Captain!’. Lincoln was the sixteenth president of the United States of America. He bears an

image of a hero in the eyes of his fellow Americans. USA in honour of his works has felicitated him on five-dollar note series.

In “O Captain! My Captain!,” the speaker has an intense amount of admiration for his captain, a stand-in for President Lincoln. The speaker’s admiration for the captain is different from that of the people on shore. The speaker has witnessed the captain’s actions first-hand. Back on land the people share in the speaker’s admiration and cheer the ship into the harbour. What the captain has done specifically to win everyone’s admiration is never really made clear in the poem but we do get the end results of his admirable action. He’s steered through rough seas and sacrificed his life to ensure the safety of the ship. The sailor seems to admire the captain as though the captain was an ideal masculine father.

In 1869, two marvels of engineering altered the course of history forever. That May, the last spike was driven into the ground on the American transcontinental railroad, connecting the country definitively from East to West. Six months later and half a world away, the Suez Canal opened in Egypt. By joining the Mediterranean Sea to the Red Sea via an artificial waterway, it allowed transportation and trade between Europe and Asia in record time, without navigating around Africa. The canal promised to change the face of world commerce, but it also extended the possibilities of cultural exchange between nations. In the poem ‘Passage to India’, the poet admires the engineers and celebrate scientific achievement that made the two marvels of engineering possible, as well also admire the people who had an imagination of making this project, a success indeed. The achievement that requires a great skill of engineering, the canal was also a triumph of the human imagination. Whitman credits both technology and arts here. The “facts of modern science” alone aren’t enough to explain the project’s completeness. Repetition plays a key role in his praise. He sees the opening of Suez Canal as both a reason for

celebration and an opportunity to connect with the spiritual traditions of faraway land. He praises the very few people who possess substantial wisdom that could imagine such possibilities, and the new era of worldliness and peace that might come of it. Whitman specially demonstrates his excitement and admiration for the achievement, for e.g.. He opens by relating the canal to both science (“proud truth of world”) and myth (and fables of eld”).

A patriot is a person who loves his country so much that he would fight to protect the rights and freedoms that the country values. In “O Captain! My Captain!”, Whitman celebrates the bond that patriotism creates between the average citizen and the leader of the people. The captain is portrayed as a patriot who has risked his life in some mission for the people on shore. The masses on shore celebrate the captain's success, and the ship’s return with all the trappings of patriotism: flags, bugles, and bells. The sense of inclusiveness is ultimately one of the sentiments Whitman is trying to convey here. Turning finally to address the soul, the launching pad for human endeavour, Whitman uses repetition for emphasis once again to give voice to what he sees as God’s purpose for the new passage to India—to bring people of all nations and races together. When “The earth be spanned connected by network” barriers are erased, love is nurtured, and people evolve. Whitman is imagining here not only the actual canal, but the broader implications of a ‘Passage to India’, a place that represents for Whitman, and no doubt many of his American readers, an exotic and foreign land. Therefore, India can be termed as an exotic foreign land. the literal passage thus becomes a metaphorical one, bridging the continents and allowing for new kinds of communion between people of all nations. Imagining a peaceful new era with his eye fixed on a higher purpose Whitman addresses all the people who made the canal possible and implores them to see not just their technological prowess but the spirituality

of their endeavour. Just as the Suez Canal links distant parts of the world, Whitman's poem links ancient religions and modern technology, God and engineering. In doing so he encourages us to see a bright future extending an invitation that is both reverent and hopeful.

In the poem 'O Captain!, My Captain!', Poet used a very simple and effective language, he uses lot of similes and metaphor. For e.g. -

*'My Captain does not answer, his lips are pale and still;
My father does not feel my arm, he has no pulse nor will;
The ship is anchor'd safe and sound, its voyage closed and done;
From fearful trip, the victor ship, comes in with object won'*

And in the poem 'Passage to India', the poet used a very scientific language by elaborating technical terms in the poem so that reader can get what is trying to demonstrate by his words about the inventions that have been in the time recently.

For e.g. -

'A worship new, I sing;
You captains, voyagers, explorers, yours!
You engineers! You architects, machinists, yours!
You, not for trade or transportation only,
But in God's name, and for thy sake, O soul.'

In the poem 'Passage to India', lines four through six employ anaphora by each starting with the word the creating a catalog of imagery that accumulates power and momentum as the poem progresses. In each succeeding line, that repetition takes a new form in Whitman's direct address "you" to the temples, fables, and towers of foreign lands. It's these exotic institutions "myths and fables" that Whitman invokes, and which occupy the lion's share of his imagination and attention. In the poem 'O Captain!, My Captain!' the poet tries to describe his journey by using the imagery, the poem depicts about the sea journey and the Lincoln falls on the floor dead. He is just lying there, unable to move, his body got cold. People are cheering up on the shore on the victory of their captain. They are whistling and blowing bugler and the church bells are ringing

on the shore. He tells the captain that people are waiting on the shore, their captain will come and address them from the deck.

UNIT V

Analysis of Crow Testament 1 Cain lifts Crow, that heavy black bird and strikes down Abel. Damn, says Crow, I guess this is just the beginning. In the first section of this piece the speaker begins with the sons of Adam and Eve. Cain uses “Crow” to kill his brother Abel. Right from the beginning of the poem “Crow” is being used by the white man without his consent. In this case, Alexie has chosen to portray Crow as a weapon. In the second half of the section Crow exclaims, professing his understanding that his mistreatment is just beginning. Crow will stand in as a symbol for the Native populations of the Americas and Alexie will take the reader through varying symbols representing the white settlers, and the present white majority of America. Crow knows, from this first brutal action that, this is just the beginning.

2 The white man, disguised as a falcon, swoops in and yet again steals a salmon from Crow’s talons. Damn, says Crow, if I could swim I would have fled this country years ago. The second section is written in a similar fashion to the first in which Crow finds himself taken advantage of. Alexie has chosen to portray the “white man” as a “falcon.” The embodiment of the white man doesn’t just appear as a falcon, he is “disguised” as one. This adds an additional level of cunning to the scene. The falcon swoops down from the sky and steals directly from Crow’s hands, or “talons.” This theft is a clear reference to the endless damage done to Native Americans, from the theft of land to the mass exterminations that took place at the hands of the United States government and all leaders in North and South America. In the shorter second half Crow reflects that if he was able to “swim” he could have “fled this country year ago.” If he had been born

with this ability, he could have let himself be taken out to sea, and away from the damage he is living in.

The Crow God as depicted in all of the reliable Crow bibles looks exactly like a Crow. Damn, says Crow, this makes it so much easier to worship myself. The speaker takes a different approach in the third section in which he further reflects on the role of religion in modern society. The poet presents for the reader “The Crow God” that appears identical to the crows that worship him. He then provides commentary that leads to an explanation of this shift. Crow is considering the absurdity of worshipping a god that looks like you. At the same time he is pointing out the vanity in this depiction. Only the “White Man” would make a god such as this, as the familiar image makes worship, so much easier...

Among the ashes of Jericho, Crow sacrifices his firstborn son. Damn, says Crow, a million nests are soaked with blood. In this section the speaker continues to describe the place of Native Americans, through the Crow metaphor. The narrative is now expanding to include other events from the bible, such as the Battle of Jericho. During this pivotal Biblical moment, the Israelites destroy the city of Jericho. In Alexie’s narrative the city stands in for the entire population of native people who were decimated by the arrival of the white man. In this case, the “ashes of Jericho” are home to the son of Crow” and, ...a million nests...soaked with blood. This destruction is their inheritance and is home to their futures. When Crows fight Crows the sky fills with beaks and talons. Damn, says Crow, it's raining feathers. Not only does Crow have to be cautious of the white man in his many forms, Crow often “fights Crow.” It is in these instances that the most damage is done and the sky seems to “rain feathers.” It is clear that any

division between the Native peoples further hurts their chances of finding a way out from under, or a way to stand up against, the white man.

Crow flies around the reservation and collects empty beer bottles but they are so heavy he can only carry one at a time. So, one by one, he returns them but gets only five cents a bottle. Damn, says Crow, redemption is not easy. The sixth section of this piece is the longest, and takes the speaker into the present day in which the suffering of the Native American people has not abated, but only changed forms. On a contemporary reservation, Crow, still seen as a representative of the Native peoples, is flying around searching for, “empty beer bottles.” The collection of these bottles provides him with a very limited income, but also serves as commentary on the health of the reservation. Alcoholism is one of the most rampant diseases on reservations and the poet’s choice to have beer bottles provide Crow with a small stipend is quite poignant. Crow battles through poverty, alcoholism, and even then, the transportation of the bottles is impossible. He is only able to carry one at a time, making his journeys back and forth endless.

Crow rides a pale horse into a crowded powwow but none of the Indian panic. Damn, says Crow, I guess they already live near the end of the world. In the final section of the poem Alexie brings the narrative to a close by referencing the end times as portrayed in Revelations. Crow rides into a “crowded powwow” on a “pale horse.” In the scene Crow has come to represent death itself. In Revelations, during the coming of the four horsemen, one rides a pale horse. This rider is Death who now finds himself within the body of a Crow. While in other circumstances this entrance would be shocking to all who observed it, in this case “none of the Indian panic.” None of the

attendees are shocked to see this rider on his pale horse, it is as if they all knew what was coming and had learned to expect it a long time ago.

Perhaps, as long ago as the days of Cain and Abel when Crow first understood his destiny.

Poem Evolution

Poem Evolution Buffalo Bill opens a pawn shop on the reservation right across the border from the liquor store and he stays open 24 hours a day, 7 days a week and the Indians come running in with jewelry television sets, a VCR, a full-length beaded buckskin outfit It took Inez Muse 12 years to finish. Buffalo Bill takes everything the Indians have to offer, keeps it all catalogues and filed in a storage room. The Indians pawn their hands, saving the thumbs for last, they pawn their skeletons, falling endlessly from the skin and when the last Indian has pawned everything but his heart, Buffalo Bill takes that for twenty bucks closes up the pawn shop, paints a new sign over the old calls his venture THE MUSEUM OF NATIVE AMERICAN CULTURES charges the Indians five bucks a head to enter. The systematic oppression of the Native American People Evolution is a powerful poem in which Sherman Alexie illustrates the systematic degradation of the Native American people and their culture.

A character in the poem, Buffalo Bill sets up a pawn shop along the border of a Native American reservation. This pawn shop was intentionally set up in right across a liquor store. Buffalo Bill manages to take many valuables from the Native Americans in exchange for some money that the Native American people will eventually spend on the liquor store. The Native American people pawn away so many things that they are left with nothing but their hearts which is eventually sold to Buffalo Bill. Once all has been taken from the Native American community

Buffalo Bill renames the shop and makes it a museum for Native American culture. Ironically, he then charges the Native Americans five dollars a person to enter. Alexie's use of Buffalo Bill is significant in that it embodies imagery and reactions from both White Americans and Native Americans. Buffalo Bill is a historically significant character in that he was known to help "civilize the west". He was prominent in that sense. However, in this poem Sherman uses Buffalo Bill as a symbol that embodies America namely the American government and white people, in their ideals and most importantly in their actions. Through this poem, Alexie manages to create an extended metaphor that highlights the deceit that the American government played against the Native American community and the subsequent usurpation of land, identity, and self that they had to endure. Although this poem is written in a historical light, what occurred in the Native American community is still affecting them to this day. Indeed the Native American people are still suffering from the Buffalo Bills of today, also known as the American government, its oppressing laws and people. Native Americans are in a current oppressed state because they have had their land, their culture /traditions, and most importantly their sense of self (identity) systematically taken away from them. It is a well-known fact that the Native American people had their land taken away from them by the European settlers that came here in the 17th century. It's a tale that many children hear in their history classes.

But what many of them don't know (and what the American government is not teaching) is the way in which their lands have been taken away. There is no doubt that there have been some violent struggles for land between Native Americans and the European settlers but what is not shown is how mainly trickery (not violence) was used to steal their lands from them. The main trick that was used to get Native Americans to sign off their lands to the Europeans was the act of introducing alcohol. The Europeans knew about alcohol's ability to create addiction,

intoxication, and impair a person's mind. So they used this as a tool to take away the valuables that Native Americans owned. Alexie illustrates this point when he writes the story of how "Buffalo Bill opens up a pawn shop on the reservation right across the border from the liquor store". Buffalo Bill knows that the Native American can't resist alcohol and systematically sets up a shop right across a liquor store so that the Native American people will feel tempted to go to the liquor stores after pawning their "jewelry, Television sets, VCR[s], and beaded buckskin outfits." He manages to make money from them "taking everything [they] have to offer" but we don't see how the Native American people benefit from this. Another thing worth noting is that Buffalo Bill "stays open 24 hours a day, 7 days a week". Alexie is showing how those who are plotting against the 52 Native Americans don't take a break, they seek to gain profit in any way they could at any time of the day. Little by little the Native Americans begin to lose all they have. A dynamic shift can be seen in what the Native American people begin to pawn to Buffalo Bill. They start off with pawning material goods such as jewelry and electronics. This is symbolizing the land that was given to the American Government. But then we begin to see how artifacts of their culture are pawned away.

Once all of the material belongings have been given away, Alexie shows the Native Americans pawning their "pawn their hands, saving the thumbs for last ...their skeletons, falling endlessly from the skin". The Native American people begin to sell their body parts, but it doesn't stop there. When everything, including their physical bodies have been lost "the last Indian pawn[s] everything but his heart, [and] Buffalo Bill takes that for twenty bucks". This is showing how after the Native Americans lost everything to the American government they ended up giving up their "hearts". Heart," here can be read as a core of the Native American identity.)The fact that the Buffalo Bill put a monetary value on the "heart" of Native Americans shows the lack of

respect the American Government had for Native Americans as a people. To the American Government the identity of Native Americans was an item that they sought to profit from. We can still see this today. Many aspects of the Native American culture are inauthentically displayed by Americans today. We can see this in movies, such as Disney's Pocahontas, in which a young Native American woman falls in love with a European settler. Although Pocahontas was an actual person in history the story of her falling in love with John Smith is a complete fabrication that John Smith (one of the European Settlers) made up himself. In addition, there are Native American themed festivals and ceremonies that are run by whites in an effort to show "appreciation" and gain an "understanding" of the Native American culture when in reality this is nothing but an insult to the Native American culture. This is briefly discussed in the novel Ceremony by Leslie Silko, in which the mayor in the city of Gallup organizes a yearly Gallup Ceremonial in which Native American dancers (from different tribes) come and perform. Also the issue of the term "Redskins" has come to light in recent news.

Redskins are a derogatory term that the Native American community as a whole agrees on. Yet, the football team named after this term defends its name and says its name is an honor to the Native American tribesmen. The American people can't seem to fathom that there are some things Native American culture that they don't understand and that some things are downright offensive. Their insistence that they are honoring the Native American culture and that they are trying to show respect is a form of denial. Denial that they stripped these people of everything they had and are now slowly taking away their true identity. These inaccurate representations of Native American culture portrayed in books, the media, and festivals creates an identity crisis in the Native American community in that they are not given a say in what their true heritage really is. This is an unusual but powerful form of oppression. The media and the government is the

current driving force of the oppression and silencing of the Native American people. It is the modern day Buffalo Bill and although it's not clear what measures should be taken to put an end to this, it is necessary for the Native American to reclaim their identity and show the world who they truly are. Pawn shops tend to represent sites of unorganized accumulation, places that gather anything and everything with the prospect of profiting from the vulnerability of others. 53 By enticing patrons with quick cash--an instantaneous materialization of value--the pawn shop successfully confiscates living objects only to deprive them of meaning by reoffering them for sale. Sherman Alexie adapts this story poignantly in "Evolution." Alexie centers the enterprise of objectification in the figure of Buffalo Bill. Also known as William F. Cody (1846-1917), Buffalo Bill, no longer just an historical figure but rather an icon now synonymous with the American West, did at least his share in exploiting Native Americans. An honorary website credits him with helping "his West to make the transition from a wild past to a progressive future." The establishment of a binary between "wild" and "progressive" subjugates Indians by placing them in the role of savages, a representation that American history has repeatedly thrust upon them. Despite supposedly championing the rights of Indians, Buffalo Bill certainly contributed to their cultural confinement in his "Wild West" shows, performances that "contained elements of the circus, the drama of the times, and the rodeo," offering a "unique form of theatrical entertainment.

The Wild West Show had as its theoretical aim the presentation of a pageant of the settling and the taming of the West" (Kramer 87). Beyond mere amusement, the shows also served as advertising campaigns to lure settlers to the West to help further tame the "uncivilized" region: The Wild West show was inaugurated in Omaha in 1883 with real cowboys and real Indians portraying the "real West." The show spent ten of its thirty years in Europe. In 1887 Buffalo Bill

was a feature attraction at Queen Victoria's Golden Jubilee. At the World's Columbian Exposition in 1893, only Egypt's gyrations rivaled the Wild West as the talk of Chicago. By the turn of the century, Buffalo Bill was probably the most famous and most recognizable man in the world. (American West) Given the legendary status history has accorded him, Buffalo Bill may be compared to other colonizing heroes in Western culture, especially those who circulated a dominant ideology as their role in enhancing domination. His ability to disseminate representations stems not only from his ubiquitous stage presence but also from the extensive publicity that presented his image. "Certainly no individual, before the days of movies and radio, ever had such effective personal exploitation. For nearly half a century he was continuously held before the public, in the pages of nickel and dime novels, on the boards in blood and thunder melodrama and in that astounding Wild West Show which toured from the tank towns to the very thrones of Europe" (Walsh 18). The title of a 1928 book, *The Making of Buffalo Bill: A Study in Heroics*, suggests that the phenomenon of Buffalo Bill was as much created by an eager audience as it was by Bill Cody. Its collective gaze, like the gaze performed by museum-goers, constructed an impervious ideal: "When they gazed upon the man himself they saw that he looked the part of hero" (Walsh 17).

Empowered with the iconic eminence of a hero, Buffalo Bill possesses the capacity and authority to reproduce and distribute cultural myths. His conception of the "real West" extends from his imaginary relation to American ideals that have themselves been formed by such hegemonic historical representations as Manifest Destiny. The posters advertising Buffalo Bill contribute to the representational subjugation of Indians, portraying them as features of a crude land that the military must rehabilitate and civilize. The illustration depicts Buffalo Bill and his entourage riding in a "civilized" wagon through a tumultuous landscape. As the central focus, they

marginalize the Indians on the borders of the painting, indeed cutting some of them off as they forcibly split the factions on both sides of their procession. The white riders stand taller than the encroaching Indians, a force that the advertisement construes as a threat to American progress. Such a hazard, the painting declares, must be vanquished by the collective gaze of American discourse, a gaze that restricts Native American culture to a territory of enclosure. 54 In "Evolution," Alexie addresses the compartmentalization and commodification of culture by supplanting Buffalo Bill's stage antics with a business venture: Buffalo Bill opens up a pawn shop on the reservation Right across the border from the liquor store and he stays open 24 hours a day, 7 days a week and the Indians come running in with jewelry, Television sets, a VCR, a full-length beaded buckskin outfit it took Inez Muse 12 years to finish. (1-6) Alexie re-appropriates history to fit the mold of a "24 hours a day, 7 days a week" contemporaneity. Placing it across the "border," rather than across the street from the liquor store, Alexie reminds us of the laws forbidding the sale of alcohol on many Indian reservations and the physical and cultural boundaries that continue to encircle them. The liquor store further calls attention to the use of alcohol as a device of suppression. Numerous historical accounts tell of white residents getting Indians drunk as a negotiation strategy to convince them to sign treaties that would yield land (Barr 7). The high rate of alcoholism that persists among Native Americans occupies a prominent position throughout all of Alexie's work.

In "Evolution," Alexie intimates that the money the Indians obtain from pawning themselves evaporates when they cross the street to purchase liquor. This vicious cycle in which everyone stands to profit from Indians except Indians themselves sustains itself because "Buffalo Bill / takes everything the Indians have to offer, keeps it / all catalogued and filed in a storage room" (6-8). Buffalo Bill scavenges all he can, classifying it with the commodifying gaze of a museum

curator. The cycle culminates in Buffalo Bill's move from collecting to exhibition: and when the last Indian has pawned everything but his heart, Buffalo Bill takes that for twenty bucks closes up the pawn shop, paints a new sign over the old calls his venture THE MUSEUM OF NATIVE AMERICAN CULTURES charges the Indians five bucks a head to enter. (11-15) By seizing the "heart" of the last Indian and subsequently closing the doors of the pawn shop, Buffalo Bill seals out the possibility of repossession. This act deprives the culture of its lifeblood. The new museum freezes "NATIVE AMERICAN CULTURES" in place, on display, behind glass cases. The painted over sign recalls the years of government manipulation of Indians in which new treaties invalidated old ones that the U.S. no longer wished to honor. The glossing over of old wounds and forms of cultural exploitation--feeding a people someone else's idea of what they should be--cap this poem with the absurd reality of a perverse history. Jane Tompkins comments on the manifestation of another absurd reality in her visit to a museum in Cody, Wyoming that enshrines Buffalo Bill himself. The existence of this memorial ironically shifts the position of the celebrated pioneer from curator to spectacle.

However, unlike the cultural deprivation enacted by the museum of Alexie's poem, the Buffalo Bill Museum petrifies the superhero status of its namesake. Both instances cast a type of paralysis--The Museum of Native American Cultures frames its objects as an exhibition of a primitive culture, a display of dry bones; The Buffalo Bill Museum, as Tompkins tells us, galvanized the golden image of an American icon: The Buffalo Bill Museum envelops you in an array of textures, colors, shapes, sizes, forms. The fuzzy brown bulk of a buffalo's hump, the sparkling diamonds in a stickpin, the brilliant colors of the posters--there's something about the cacophonous mixture that makes you want to walk in and be surrounded by it, as if you were going into a child's adventure story. It all appeals to the desire to be transported, to pretend for a

little while that we're cowboys or cowgirls; it's a museum where fantasy can take over. In this respect, it is true to the character of Buffalo Bill's life. (Tompkins 530) 55 The fantasy of Buffalo Bill's life is the fantasy projected onto it by the gaze of a hungry audience. For years Americans and viewers around the world stood captivated by the Wild West Show, feeding off its depictions of conquest, control, and violence. Tompkins gives us the severe yet appropriate metaphor that "museums are a form of cannibalism made safe for polite society," serving as venues that "cater to the urge to absorb the life of another into one's own life" (533). This remark accords with an attitude Alexie voices throughout his work. The dominant culture devours its subordinates to sustain its stance as an enforcer. "The objects in museums preserve for us a source of life from which we need to nourish ourselves when the resources that would normally supply us have run dry" (Tompkins 533). The act of sapping resources from another culture again points to the narrative of "Evolution," a title that drips with the irony of the concept of civilization. A civilized culture, Alexie implies, must "evolve" enough to perfect the practice of stealing and plundering other cultures for the purpose of presenting them as uncivilized behind the glass case of the museum. We too, Tompkins reminds us, are onlookers. "We stand beside the bones and skins and hooves of beings that were once alive, or stare fixedly at their painted images. Indeed our visit is only a safer form of the same enterprise" (533) rehearsed by Buffalo Bill's Wild West show--cultural objectification and destruction.

A Rose for Emily

The narrator recalls the time of Emily Grierson's death and how the entire town attended the funeral in her large, once-grand home, which no stranger had entered for more than ten years. Colonel Sartoris, the town's previous mayor, had suspended Emily's tax responsibilities to the town after her father's death, justifying the action by claiming that Mr. Grierson had once lent

the community a significant sum. As new town leaders took over, they made unsuccessful attempts to get Emily to resume payments. When confronted by town officials, Emily refused and told the men to talk to Colonel Sartoris, who at this point has been dead almost ten years.

The narrator describes a time thirty years earlier when Emily resisted another official inquiry, when the townspeople detected a powerful odor emanating from her property. Her father had just died, and Emily had been abandoned by the man whom the townsfolk believed Emily was to marry. As complaints mount, Judge Stevens, the mayor at the time, decided to have lime sprinkled along the foundation of the Grierson home in the middle of the night. Within a couple of weeks, the odor subsided, but the townspeople began to pity the increasingly reclusive Emily. The day after Mr. Grierson's death, the women of the town called on Emily to offer their condolences. Meeting them at the door, Emily stated that her father was not dead, a charade that she kept up for three days. She finally turned her father's body over for burial.

The narrator describes a long illness that Emily suffered after this incident. A construction company arrived in town to pave the sidewalks, under the direction of northerner Homer Barron. Homer soon became a popular figure in town and was seen taking Emily on buggy rides on Sunday afternoons, which caused a scandal; the town felt she was forgetting her family pride, becoming involved with a man beneath her station. One day, she went to the drug store to purchase arsenic, a powerful poison. She was required by law to reveal how she would use the arsenic. She offered no explanation, and the package arrived at her house labeled "For rats." The narrator describes the fear that some of the townspeople had that Emily would use the poison to kill herself. Her potential marriage to Homer seemed increasingly unlikely, despite their continued Sunday ritual. A Baptist minister talked to with Emily, but after his visit, he never

spoke of what happened and swore that he'd never go back. The minister's wife wrote to Emily's two cousins in Alabama, who arrived for an extended stay. Because Emily ordered a silver toilet set monogrammed with Homer's initials, talk of the couple's marriage resumed.

Written by Nobel Prize winning author William Faulkner and published in 1930, "A Rose for Emily" is a Southern Gothic short story that weaves a tale of mystery, decay, and the complexities of the human psyche. Set in the town of Jefferson, Mississippi, the narrative centers around Emily Grierson, an eccentric and reclusive woman from a once-respected Southern family. Faulkner employs a non-linear narrative style, revealing the events of Emily's life in a fragmented manner, building suspense and intrigue. The decaying antebellum mansion of the Griersons serves as a powerful backdrop, mirroring Emily's own decline and the fading glory of the Old South. The story explores themes of isolation, expectations, and the impact of time on individuals and communities. Emily's character becomes a symbol of resistance to change, reflecting the tensions between tradition and progress in the post-Civil War South.

Faulkner's exploration of the Southern Gothic genre, characterized by its use of macabre and eerie elements within a Southern setting, is evident throughout "A Rose for Emily." The story has become a staple in American literature, studied for its rich symbolism and Faulkner's masterful narrative technique. Explore the full story summary, an in-depth character analysis of Emily Grierson, and explanations of important quotes from "A Rose for Emily."

